

ICE Brent continues to find support around the \$100/bbl level, with geopolitical risks outweighing an improvement in the supply picture



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Persian Gulf, the market remains nervous about potential supply disruptions from the region. This is keeping prices well-supported for now. This nervousness is likely to persist until there are signs of progress in a deal between the US and Iran. In the meantime, the risk of further escalation remains very real.

Reports yesterday said Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline was targeted again. It only recently returned to operation following an earlier attack. Though the latest attack doesn't appear to have disrupted flows through the pipeline, it's a reminder that flows remain at risk.

Oil producers in the Persian Gulf continue to adapt to the region's situation. Kuwait said that it is producing at 75% of pre-war levels, while the Saudis also cut the official selling price of their Arab Light into Asia for November loadings, a sign of an improving supply picture.

The European gas market remains vulnerable, despite signs of a more recent pick-up in LNG flows from the Persian Gulf. EU gas storage is just shy of 73% full. This is down from 83% at the same stage last year, and below the 5-year average of 88%. While injections have been stronger than the seasonal average through September, the region will still struggle to hit storage targets ahead

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In precious metals, gold edged higher as investors sought safe-haven assets amid growing fiscal concerns in Europe. However, gains may remain capped by elevated Treasury yields, persistent inflation concerns and a firmer US dollar.

Agriculture — Sugar rally extends on supply concerns

Sugar prices rose for a third consecutive session, with No. 11 raw sugar climbing more than 4% and breaking above USc20/lb. The rally is being driven by mounting concerns over tightening global

supplies as adverse weather conditions threaten production across key producing regions. El Niño-related disruptions have shifted market expectations from a projected surplus earlier in the year to a potential global deficit.

In Brazil, excessive rainfall has disrupted cane harvesting and crushing operations, contributing to a sharp decline in Center-South sugar production. In India, below-normal monsoon rainfall has lowered production forecasts, while European sugar beet yields are expected to be 11% below the five-year average.

Data from Ukraine's Agriculture Ministry shows that grain and

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